

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD REPORT
☐ RARE OR UNUSUAL RECORD ☒ NEW STATE RECORD

CFO-ORC FILE NO. N-19-77
☐ ACCEPTED ☐ REJECTED

A

Species: RUFF/REEVE

Philomachus pugnax

(Vernacular Name)

(Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): May 30, 1977

Time Bird Seen: 3:10 P.M. to 3:30 P.M.

Locality: Small farm pond about 1 1/2 miles northeast of Prospect Reservoir at the

Nearest Town: junction of Weld Co. roads 6 and 61 County: Keenesburg, Weld Cou

Other observers who independently identified this bird:

NAME

ADDRESS

TELEP

Robert Andrews - 1390 South Ivy Way, Denver, Colorado

Steve Larson - 2637 Valmont, #44, Boulder, Colorado

Seen by many other observers.

Optical Equipment: 10X50 Bushnell Binoculars; 15X-60X Zoom Telescope

If photographed, type of equipment used: _____

Light Conditions: Sunlight directly upon bird; bright, clear afternoon

Distance from bird (how measured): 25 feet (estimated)

Probably a

Number of Birds Seen: One Sex: male Plumage: Non-breeding

Describe the bird's overall behavior and demeanor:

First observed feeding on mud flat with Spotted Sandpiper (*Actitis macularia*), ten Northern Phalaropes (*Lobipes lobatus*). Very aggressive in driving off the Spotted Sandpiper and Northern Phalaropes whenever approached too closely. Fe dabbling or picking at mud. When flushed, it circled the pond a couple of time finally coming to rest in the middle of the pond in deeper water with the North Phalaropes. It appeared to be swimming at this point although water may not have been that deep. The bird quickly returned to the same spot from whence it had

Describe in great detail the bird's size, overall shape, plumage and color-pattern.

Include details on shape of bill, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to the marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance in field guide descriptions is not enough. Describe what you actually saw in the field:

A medium-sized shorebird about 11"-12" in length when compared to the Spotted Sandpiper (roughly 8") and the Northern Phalarope (7") which were with the bird for direct comparison. Erect stance on rather short legs. Overall coloration rich brown upper parts; paler under parts. Bill, dark gray; thicker at base and tapering toward tip. Bill slightly longer than head with just a hint of a downward curve to it. There was a rather pronounced whitish area completely encircling the base of the bill. Crown, face and nape areas, brown. Pale but noticeably white eye ring. No superciliary mark. Eye, dark. Throat, whitish. Bre and sides soft brownish-pink blending into white from belly to under tail coverts. No barring or markings on breast and sides. Under tail coverts, pure white, unmarked. Back and wing coverts, rich brown feathers with pale edges which provided a very noticeable scalloped appearance. Legs, orange-yellow. In flight, pale white wing stripe. Also when in flight, white oval patch on either side at base of tail separated by dark central area. Rest of tail, black. Shape of tail, square. A couple of times as the bird turned to preen itself, it would raise wing slightly displaying the white oval patch. (NOTE: I saw the bird again on June 4, 1977 at the same location at about 1:30 P.M. for about 30 minutes. This apparently was the last observation.)

(OVER)

Describe the bird's song or call, if heard, including method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight, etc:

The bird was silent and gave no flight call.

Describe the habitat in which you observed this bird:

Small fresh-water pond about 150 yards long and 50 yards wide with exposed mud flats.

How were similarly appearing species eliminated?

BUFF-BREASTED SANDPIPER: Much smaller (would be roughly the same size as the Spotted Sandpiper); even buff color throughout under parts. This species does not show large white patches at base of tail when in flight.

PECTORAL SANDPIPER: Smaller with sharp contrast between brown breast and white belly. Back, streaked. Also does not show long white patches at base of tail.

RED KNOT: Roughly the same size-wise but more of a chunky shorebird. Has whitish rump and grayish tail which is completely different than in Ruff. Would have prominent reddish underparts throughout in breeding plumage.

Prior experience with this and similarly appearing species:

Have never seen this species before. Have seen the Buff-breasted Sandpiper once in Colorado. Have seen great numbers of Red Knots on the East Coast over the years. Also have seen many Pectoral Sandpipers throughout the eastern United States and Colorado.

Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation?

BIRDS OF NORTH AMERICA, Robbins, Brunn, Zim, Singer; COLLINS POCKET GUIDE TO BRITISH BIRDS, Fitter & Richardson; BIRDS OF EUROPE, Brunn, Singer, Campbell; A FIELD GUIDE TO THE BIRDS OF BRITAIN AND EUROPE, Peterson, Mountfort & Hollom. All assisted in supporting my conclusions on the observation.

This report was written from notes made during X after X observation; from memory

PRINT NAME: JACK REDDALL

SIGNATURE: Jack Reddall

DATE: May 31, 1977

Street Address: 4450 South Alton Street

Town and State: Englewood, Colo. ZIP: 80110

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 4450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD ☒ UNUSUAL RECORD ☐ **A**

Please print or type. Attach photographs and additional pages if necessary.

Species: RUFF Philomachus pusillus
(Vernacular Name) (Scientific Name)Date(s): 30 May 1977; 1 June 1977Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: Male (probably) Plumage: subadult, breedingLocality: (junction of roads 6 and 61)
ponds about 3 miles northeast of Prospect Reservoir Elevation: about 5000 ft.Nearest town: Hudson or Prospect Valley County: WeldTime(s) observed: about 7 PM on 30 May; mid-afternoon on 1 JuneDuration of observation (e.g. 1 sec., 5 min., etc.): continuously for about 30 minutes.

Other observers who saw the bird with you (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

Harry Knapp
Steve Larson
Hugh Kingery

Other observers who saw the bird independently (give names, addresses, telephone numbers):

Jack Reddall (he found the bird). Also many other observers subsequently.

Light conditions (position of bird to light and shade, direction and strength of light):

Mostly cloudy on 30 May. Bright and sunny on 1 June.Optical equipment used (e.g. power, types): 15-60X Zoom telescope; 10 X 50 binocularsDistance, and how measured: Minimum estimated distance about 30-35 ft.

If photographed, type of equipment and film: _____

Who else photographed the bird? Bill Lybarger, Steve Larson, Harold Holt(?)

Describe the bird's behavior (e.g. flying, feeding, or habits used in identifying):

Foraging belly-deep in the ponds, sometimes even swimming on the surface. Also observed in flight around the 3-4 ponds in the vicinity.

Describe in detail the bird's relative size, overall shape, plumage and color pattern.

Include details of bill, wing and tail shape. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance to field guide descriptions and illustrations is not enough. Describe only what you actually observed in the field:

Medium-sized shorebird. Head, neck and breast rich, deep rufous-brown, with some dark speckling on the side of the breast, and on the crown. White on the base on the bill (not on the bill itself but on the face-as in a female scaup). Back brown with the individual feathers edged with white producing a richly scalloped or scaled appearance. Lower flanks and undertail coverts white, with black barring on the flanks. Upperwing in flight brown with one fairly thin white wing-stripe. Underwing in flight white-brown. In flight, and sometimes when not, the distinctive rump pattern could be seen. This consisted of two large, oval white patches on either side of the rump, with a thin area of black between them. Rest of tail brownish. Legs fairly long, pale yellow. Bill medium-long, moderately thick, straight, black. The rich coloration of the bird indicated it was probably not a female (Reeve), and the lack of a ruff indicated the bird was not an adult male. There was a slight tendency of general darkening of the plumage noticed by observers during the duration of its stay (to about 5 or 6 June).

(OVER)

Description, (continued)

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery, (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration):

None heard.

Describe the general and specific habitat in which you observed the bird:

Small series of farm ponds in open agricultural country.

How did you eliminate similarly appearing species?

The presence of the two large oval white rump patches is diagnostic for Philomachus pugnax. This mark was very clearly seen on many occasions by myself, and also by many other observers. As far as actually identifying the species, this is about the only significant plumage mark, since plumages of males are so extraordinarily variable. The plumage of this bird carried some resemblance to that of a breeding-plumaged Curlew Sandpiper, but of course the larger size, yellow legs, non-decurved bill and eliminated that possibility even without the oval rump patches.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species?

I have never before seen Philomachus pugnax.

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification: Standard field guides consulted, and confirmed

a) at time of observation:

identification based on rump patches.

b) after observation:

(on 30 May)

This report was written from notes made during X, after observation; from memory

Date and time report was written: 29 January 1978

Reporting observer: Robert Andrews

Signature: Robert Andrews

Address: 1390 So Ivy Way, Denver, Colorado 80224

All reports will be maintained permanently at the address below.

Return to: CURATOR, DEPARTMENT OF ZOOLOGICAL COLLECTIONS
DENVER MUSEUM OF NATURAL HISTORY,
CITY PARK
DENVER, COLORADO 80205

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD REPORT
☒ RARE OR UNUSUAL RECORD ☐ NEW STATE RECORD

CFO-ORC FILE # 4Species: REEVE (RUFF)

(Vernacular Name)

1 PHILOMACHUS PUGNAX

(Scientific Name-use binomial)

Date(s): May 31, 1977 Time Bird Seen: 1700 to 1705Locality: Weld County Highway Intersection of #6 and #61Rest Town: Prospect Valley County: WELD

X Other observers who identified this bird:

NAME

ADDRESS

TELEPHONE

no one

Optical Equipment: 8X and 16X binoculars, Hensoldt
 Light Conditions: Sunlight, back lighting (sun on my back)
 Distance from Bird (how measured): 100 ft (estimated)

Number of Birds Seen: 1 Sex: female Plumage: Summer adult femaleOverall Appearance and Size: It was a little larger and chunkier than the Spotted Sandpiper that I had seen just a moment before, 4 ft from

Detailed Description (describe only what was actually observed in the field):

Bill (shape and color): a bit longer than bill of Spotted Sandp., dark colorLegs (shape and color): a bit longer than Spotted Sandp., dark color, greenishCrown and Forehead: diffused dk brown Eye (color): darkNape: white Face: white Throat: whiteBreast and Sides: like large scales of dark brownish blackBelly and Flanks: these same "scales" to middle of belly (where legs come up)Undertail Coverts: whiteBack: these same dark scales but a bit smaller than on breast & belly.Wings: whiteUnderwings: whiteRump: whiteUppertail Coverts: whiteUpper Side of Tail: whiteUnder Side of Tail: whiteShape of Tail: whiteVoice: 2 syllable, "too-it, too-it", high pitched, very fast, and loud, as it joined the Ruff as they flew off the pond.X Behavior: I saw it for just moments as it looked about to see if it were safe to start to forage.X Habitat: small storage pond, cattails on one edge, grassy area on other

Prior Experience with this Species:

Had seen in Europe

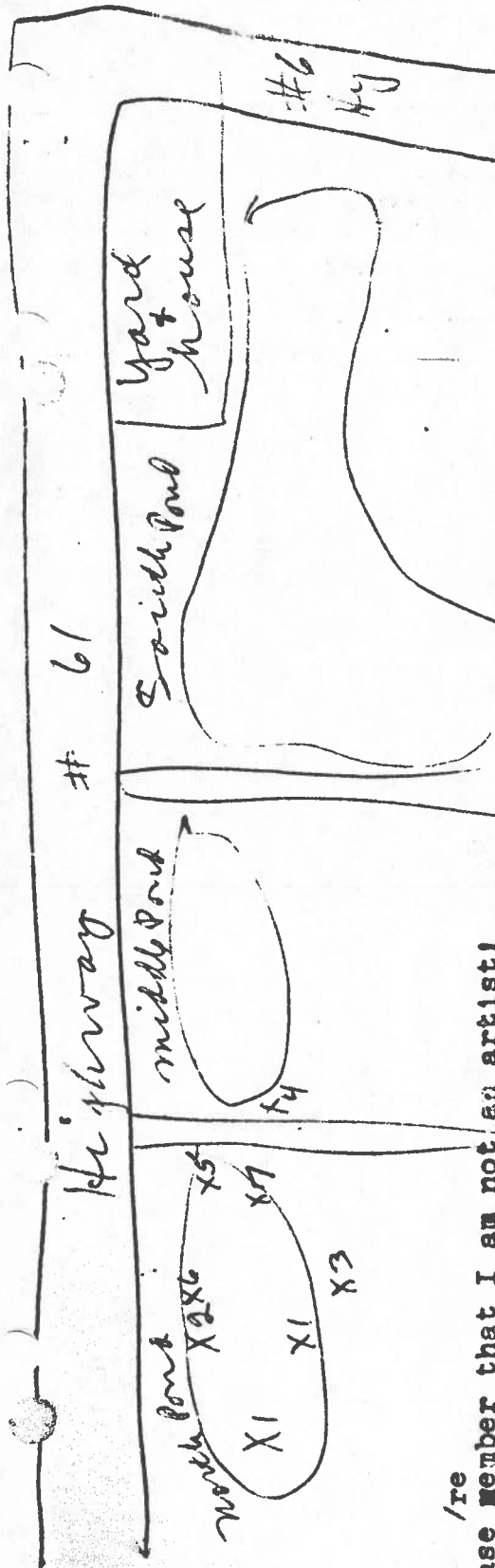
How Were Similarly Appearing Species Eliminated? It was so very dark all the way down breast and half of belly - like no other of our shore birds, such huge dark scales.

This Report was Written From: Notes made during-- after ☒ observation; Memory ☒Signed: Mildred O. Snyder Street Address: 161 Del Mar CircleDate Prepared: 6/17/77 Town and State: Aurora, ColoZip 800

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 4450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110

(FOR REMITTANCE BY CHECK OR CREDIT CARD TO BE RETURNED TO THE DONOR)

N-19-77



/re

Please remember that I am not an artist!

This is diagram of the 3 ponds at Weld Co. highways 6 & 61, Colorado. Tuesday May 31, 1977. I was scrunched down in grasses on west shore (X3), had been here one hour, watching the Ruff (X1) feeding. I happened to look across the pond, first saw a Spotted Sandpiper (X6), then saw a Reeve (X2) at edge of rushes. Then my tripod tipped over (I was using 16X binoculars, Hensoldt) and when I looked back, I did not see the bird. Then the Ruff (X1) started to fly toward the south pond and when it was at X5 it was joined by a bird that came from the X2 spot, they gave 2 high-pitched, very fast, loud calls, sorta 2 syllable-like, too-it, too-it when they were about 6 feet apart, as they flew over the dike and on over the middle pond. The pump house (X4) was in the way so I could not see how far they went, if to middle or south pond. I could not find them in either place afterwards, and anyhow it was time I started for home. I had seen a Spotted Sandpiper at X7 earlier also.

My first thought when I saw the bird at first was that "my goodness, Spotted Sandpipers don't get this dark in summer plumage!" and it was not teetering. The Spotted Sandpiper had retreated into the rushes so I did not see the 2 of them together, but the Spotted first, and then the Reeve. It was very dark, like large dark scales way down to middle of belly, above the legs.

In THE HANDBOOK OF BRITISH BIRDS by H.F. Witherby, F.C.R. Jourdain, N.P. Ticehurst and B.W. Tucker, Volume 4, is a color plate that shows the adult female summer plumage that this bird had.

M. O. Snyder

(N-19-77

